HEROES OF NORMANDIE

BATTLE OF THE BULGE

The first bloody snow in the Ardennes

No holds barred between the 82nd Airborne Division and Leibstandarte Adolf Hitler



Historical Introduction :

December 17, 1944 :

The Germans have broken through the American lines in the Ardennes. When checking for immediately available reserve units to counter the attack, General Eisenhower has to rely on the XVIII Airborne Corps resting in Champagne-Ardenne. Not the perfect choice since the Corps is not at all equipped for a winter campaign, lots of its soldiers are on leave and munition stocks are woefully low, to make matters worse.

The simple fact that this Corps happens to be just a few hours away from the endangered sector means the job is now theirs. Even though "Ike" hadn't planned on deploying this unit before the spring of 1945, he has no other choice now but to link the 82nd and the 101st Airborne divisions to the 1st US Army already stationed in the Belgian Ardennes. General Gavin, temporary commander of the Corps, proceeds with alacrity to Hodges' HQ at Spa, Belgium. Meanwhile, sufficient trucks are gathered to transport about 25 000 men. Gavin and Hodges send the 101st to Bastogne and the 82nd to Werbomont, 20 km South of Spa. On December 19 , the 82nd Airborne takes up positions along the rivers Salm and Amblève. After the passage of Kampfgruppe Peiper, the sector is calm but the Americans are bracing themselves for the appearance of the rest of the 1 SS Leibstandarte Adolf Hitler.

Campaign Victory Conditions :

Each scenario Victory brings 3
Campaign Victory Points (CVP) to the winner.
Both players score 1 CVP in case of a draw.
The player who scored the most "regular"
Victory Points (for destroying enemy units)
at the end of a scenario, is granted 1 Bonus CVP.
The player with the most CVP
at the end of the Campaign is the victor.
The player who did not win the previous scenario
can draw one Bonus Tactic.
Players can hold on to a maximum of 2 Bonus Tactics
and use them as they see fit, at a later stage
during the Campaign.

Special Rules :

The following Special Rules apply to all scenarios of this Campaign.

Special Cards :

Throughout the campaign :
-the German Paratroop cards can be added to the German card deck and may be used to aid the SS troops.
-the US Airborne Cards can be added to the US card deck but **only** US Paratroops can benefit from them.

Maximum once per scenario, if the US player has the opportunity to play a **"Scavenging"** card, this can also be used to obtain one **"Panzerfaust"** even if the defeated German unit was not equipped with such an antitank weapon.





Wheatfields :

Since it's wintertime, treat all wheatfields as clear terrain.

Objectives :

Objectives are not removed after control.
A controlling player is not compelled to keep a friendly unit next to an objective in order to maintain control, as long as no enemy unit is adjacent to the objective as well of course.
The controlling player with a unit already adjacent to an objective retains control even if an enemy unit also moves next to the objective to contest it.
Only if the controller no longer has any units adjacent to the objective but at least one enemy unit is still positioned next to it, then control passes to the opponent.

In September, close to Nijmegen (Operation Market Garden), the 504th PIR actually captured a truckload of Panzerfausts.



American recruitment tiles.

Unless specifically stated otherwise, all American recruitment tiles and heroes used in this campaign are considered as serving in the 82nd Airborne Division and use the Division Symbol shown on the title page instead of their original one.

Chapter 1 :

Cheneux

1-A : First approach.
1-B : Another attempt.
1-C : The fall of Cheneux.

Chapter 2 :

Trois Ponts

2-A : Nocturnal contact.
2-B : The attack of KG Hansen
2-C : The lost opportunity.

Required Material :

Core Box/ D-Day/ River Set
St Mere-Eglise scenario pack
Carentan scenario pack
US & GE Extra Vehicle
1st SS punchboard
SS panzergrenadiere punchboard
Gazette #1/ P&P Battleground Set Woods & Hills
Brian punchboard
Jamie « Clem » Kilmister
4th Armored Division

References :

Ligne de Front #56, Edition Caraktère, 2015

Thia74 (Pascale Guet) 2018

1-A FIRST APPROACH

Cheneux, December 20, 1944 :

At Cheneux, the Germans got hold of the bridge across the Amblève river and, according to several civilians, about one hundred enemy vehicles have already passed through the town. As this is a serious threat to the Americans, Colonel Tucker of the 504th regiment quickly reports this to General Gavin, not knowing that Peiper is meanwhile stuck at Stoumont and La Gleize due to lack of fuel.
Immediately the Colonel is ordered to retake both town and bridge without delay. Ltc Willard Harrison's 1st battalion will carry out the assault. Alas, only B and C companies are available, whilst the fog rules out any artillery support.
The attackers will have to make do with a captured SdKfz 215/9 Stummel...



COMPOSITION OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF B COMPANY, 504TH PIR





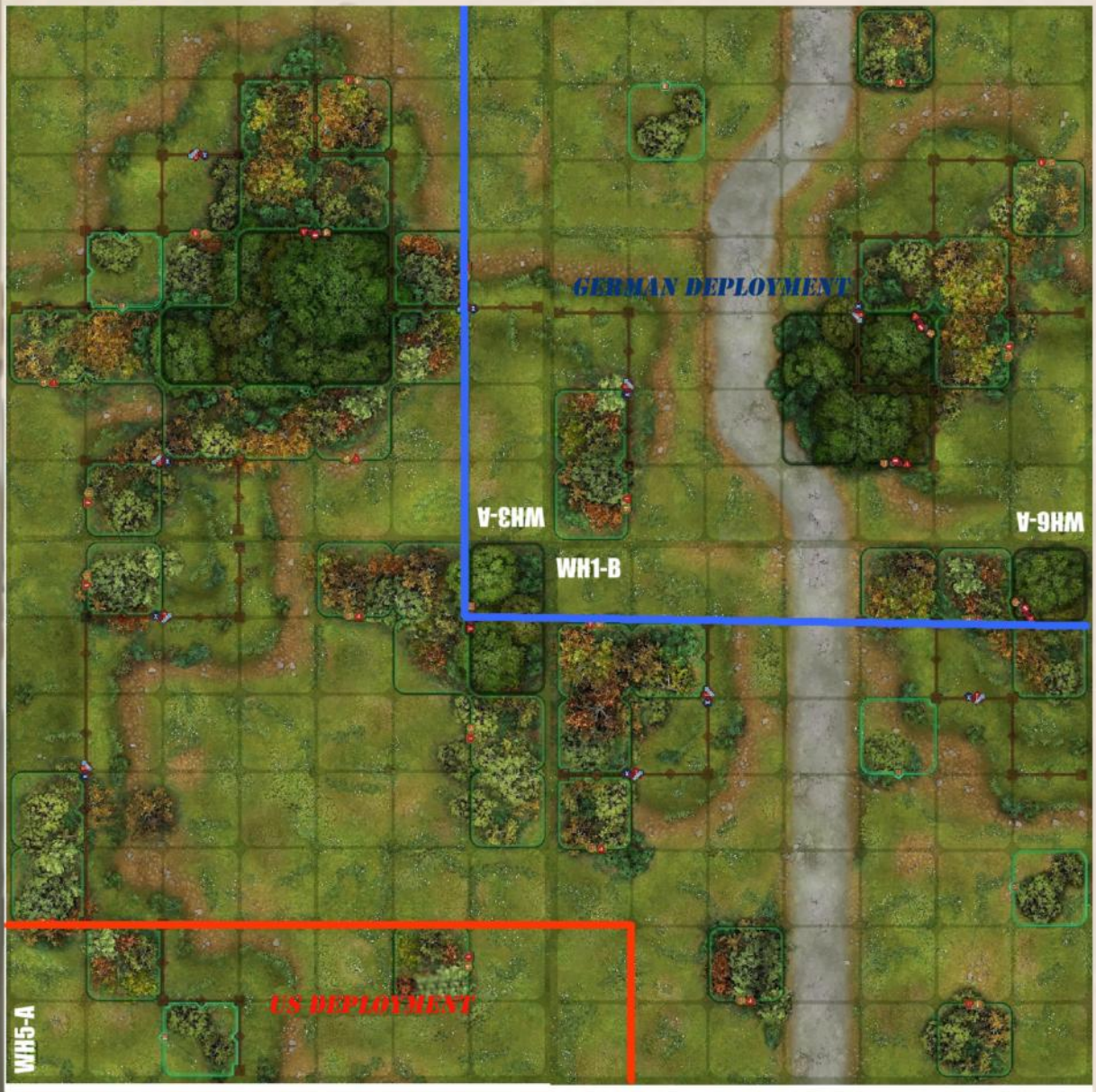


ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE PEIPER





BATTLEFIELD





PREPARATION

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from both American and German card decks.
The American player has **Initiative** but the German player deploys first.
Both players draw **4** cards.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

At the end of the scenario, the US player wins if there are at least **3** American infantry units positioned no further than **2** squares from the road, on terrain tile **WH6-A**.

SPECIAL RULES

The Americans can freely use the captured Stummel.
Remove one **"Scavenging"** Airborne card from the US deck as compensation.
Weather conditions : **"Fog"**.

EPILOGUE

Two companies of SS Panzer-Grenadiers as well as most of the leichte Flak-Abteilung 84 are entrenched in the town.
By late afternoon the paratroops' B company attempts a first approach along the Rahier-Cheneux road with the Stummel up front.
Unfortunately the fog is not dense enough to provide sufficient cover.
As the Stummel quickly runs out of ammo and the approach is blocked,
B company is forced to retreat at dusk.

1-B ANOTHER ATTEMPT

Cheneux, December 20, 1944 :

Because the first assault was not a success, Tucker orders another one and puts two M36 from the 703rd TD Bn at Harrison's disposition. At about 1930 hrs, companies B and C start the attack but their advance is greatly impeded by the barbed wire fences that surround the very fields they are trying to cross.
After some difficult progress Harrison notices that the tanks have fallen behind and urges them to keep up with the paratroops. A heated discussion ensues, both M36 trundle for a mere hundred metres more, then come to a halt, their crews refusing to move any further...



COMPOSITION OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF B COMPANY, 504TH PIR AND 703RD TANK DESTROYER BATTALION











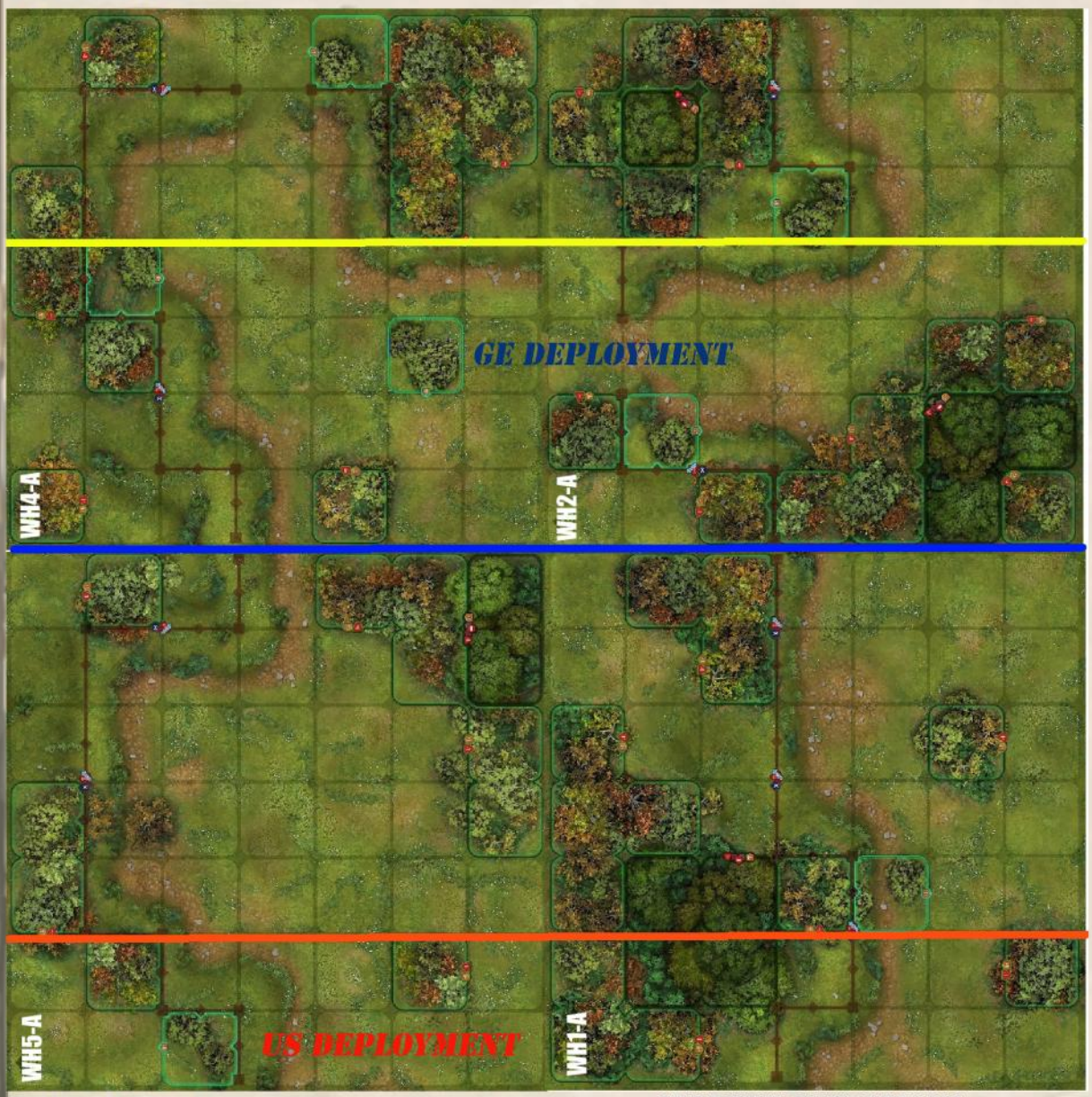
ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE PEIPER







BATTLEFIELD





PREPARATION

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards
from both American and German card decks.
The American player has initiative
but the German player deploys first.
Both players draw **4** cards.

SPECIAL RULES

In the German deployment zone,
the German player can place :
either **one** "two-square" defensive position
or **two** "one-square" defensive positions.
6 barbed wire tokens set up in two lines of **3** pieces
but none can be placed adjacent to one another.
Each of the lines must run
parallel to the blue deployment line.
The **"M10 Tank Destroyer"** can enter during the
Supply phase after a die roll with a result equal to
or lower than the current turn number.
The US player cannot use the Airborne cards.
"Dark Night" conditions apply.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

At the end of the scenario, the US player wins
if there are at least **4** American infantry units
positioned in the sector shown on the map
above the yellow line.

Epilogue

*The SS troops are entrenched in Cheneux and vicinity. They detect the advancing paratroops and unleash a terrible fusillade. The Americans, caught in barbed wire and pinned down by gunfire seem destined to be massacred. Just then, Staff Sergeant William Walsh manages to jump up whilst hollering : "Let's get these sons of b*****s before they kill us all!" Even though being wounded he manages to destroy a Flak wagon with a grenade. Triggered by this action, the other paratroops seem to have lost all sense of fear despite the heavy enemy fire. They follow closely behind Sgt Walsh, hurl themselves at the entrenched SS and take the German front lines before Cheneux.*

1-C THE FALL OF CHENEUX

Cheneux, December 21, 1944 :

Harrison needs to utter some serious threats whilst brandishing his pistol, to get both M36 tanks to advance. They knock out a Puma.
The paratroops enter Cheneux from the west.
After Harrison strengthens Company B with a platoon of Engineers he can manage to hold his position but is still lacking sufficient forces to mop up the town.
Tucker sends the 3/504th commanded by LtC Julian Cook as reinforcements...



COMPOSITION OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF B COMPANY, 1/504TH PIR AND G COMPANY 3/504TH PIR





A





B

ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE PEIPER





A



B

BATTLEFIELD



A





B



PREPARATION

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from both American and German card decks.
Map A : Use the German and American **A units**.
The German player has initiative and enters through the east side of the map but the American player deploys first.
Map B : Use the German and American **B units**.
The American player has initiative and enters through the south side of the map but the German player deploys first.
Both players draw **4** cards.

SPECIAL RULES

On **map B**, infantry units may move onto bridge squares even if these are covered by a vehicle wreck.
Orders are **not** pooled together and divided between maps.
Orders generated on a map must be allocated to units on that same map.
Hence, **A units** use only their own orders on **map A**, similarly, **B units** use nothing but their own orders on **map B**.
Both sides receive **1** Bluff order token.
This token can be placed on either map each turn.
"Fog" weather conditions apply.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

The German player must control **2** buildings on **map A**.
The American player must control **1** bridge square on **map B**.
If both sides achieve their goal, the game ends in a draw.
If neither player succeeds, both sides suffer defeat.

Epilogue

Throughout the day, Harrison must repel several German counterattacks.
Meanwhile, Cook has assembled his battalion and departs on a flanking move.
Late in the afternoon they dominate the bridge as they occupy a nearby elevated position.
In the evening the SS prefer to disengage and get out of Cheneux rather than risk getting caught in a pincer movement.
Serious fuel shortages force them to abandon about thirty vehicles.
The right bank of the Amblève river is once again secured by the Allies but at a terrible cost.
B & C Companies of 1/504 th, now reduced to only 56 men and 3 officers, have paid dearly for their victory...

2-A NOCTURNAL CONTACT

Wanne road, December 21, 1944, 0300hrs :

During December 20, LcT Vandervoort's 2/505th deploys at Trois-Ponts. D Company finds an intact bridge and even though it couldn't possibly support any tanks, it is promptly destroyed by the 307 th Engineer Battalion. Lt Bill Meddaugh orders his E company to occupy the high ground on the east bank of the Salm river in order to block any traffic coming from Wanne.



COMPOSITION OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF E COMPANY, 2/505TH PIR



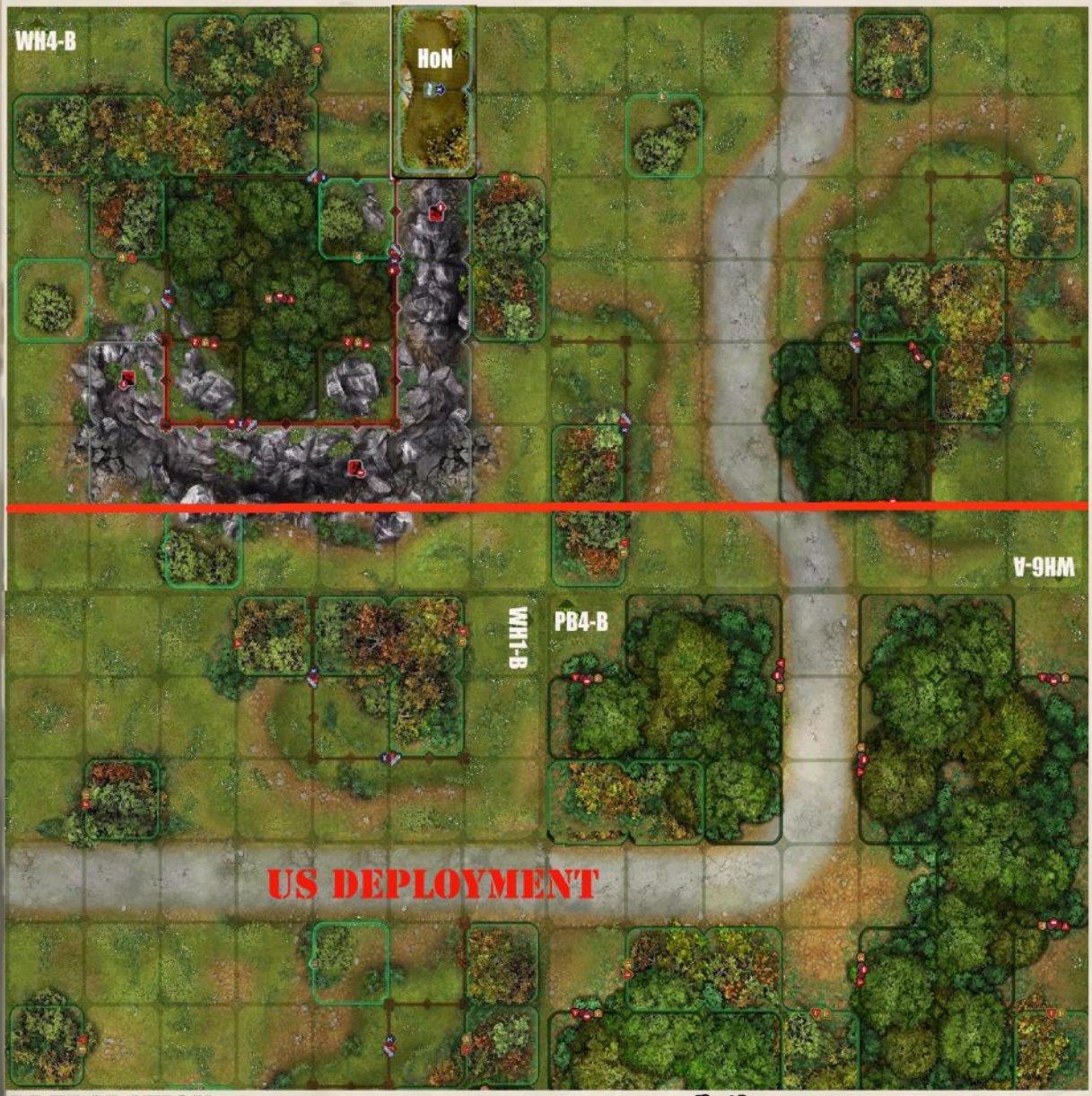


ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE HANSEN, 1 SS PANZER DIVISION





BATTLEFIELD





PREPARATION

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from both American and German card decks.
The German player has initiative but the American player deploys first.
Both players draw **4** cards.

SPECIAL RULES

German units enter through the north side of terrain tile **WH6-A**.
Vehicles cannot cross ***contour lines*** between different elevations.
"Infiltrated" can only be used by **" Concealed"** units.
"Dark night" conditions apply.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

The German player wins if **2** German vehicles manage to leave the map through the west side of terrain tile **WH1-B** by the end of the game.
Any of the "*sd kfz" halftracks* and the "*Zündapp*" motorcycle are all valid vehicles for this purpose.

Epilogue

During the night of December 20 to 21, the paratroops try to get some rest despite the cold.
At 0300 hrs they are alerted by two explosions. The vanguard of Kampfgruppe Hansen suffers the loss of two halftracks due to the mines and bazookas of E company, entrenched in an advanced position.
The SS fall back after a brief skirmish. Kampfgruppe Hansen has received orders to cross the Salm river at Trois-Ponts...

2-B THE ATTACK OF KG HANSEN

Trois-Ponts, December 21, 1944 :
With support of armored vehicles, Kampfgruppe Hansen assaults Easy Company at Trois Ponts, shortly after dawn.
Lt Bill Meddaugh asks the battalion for aid :
"Immediately, several 81 mm mortars unleashed a barrage upon the Germans, right in front of 2 nd platoon where the situation was most critical. Lt Cooper joined us to direct the fire of his mortars and make the shots count."



COMPOSITION OF THE ARMIES

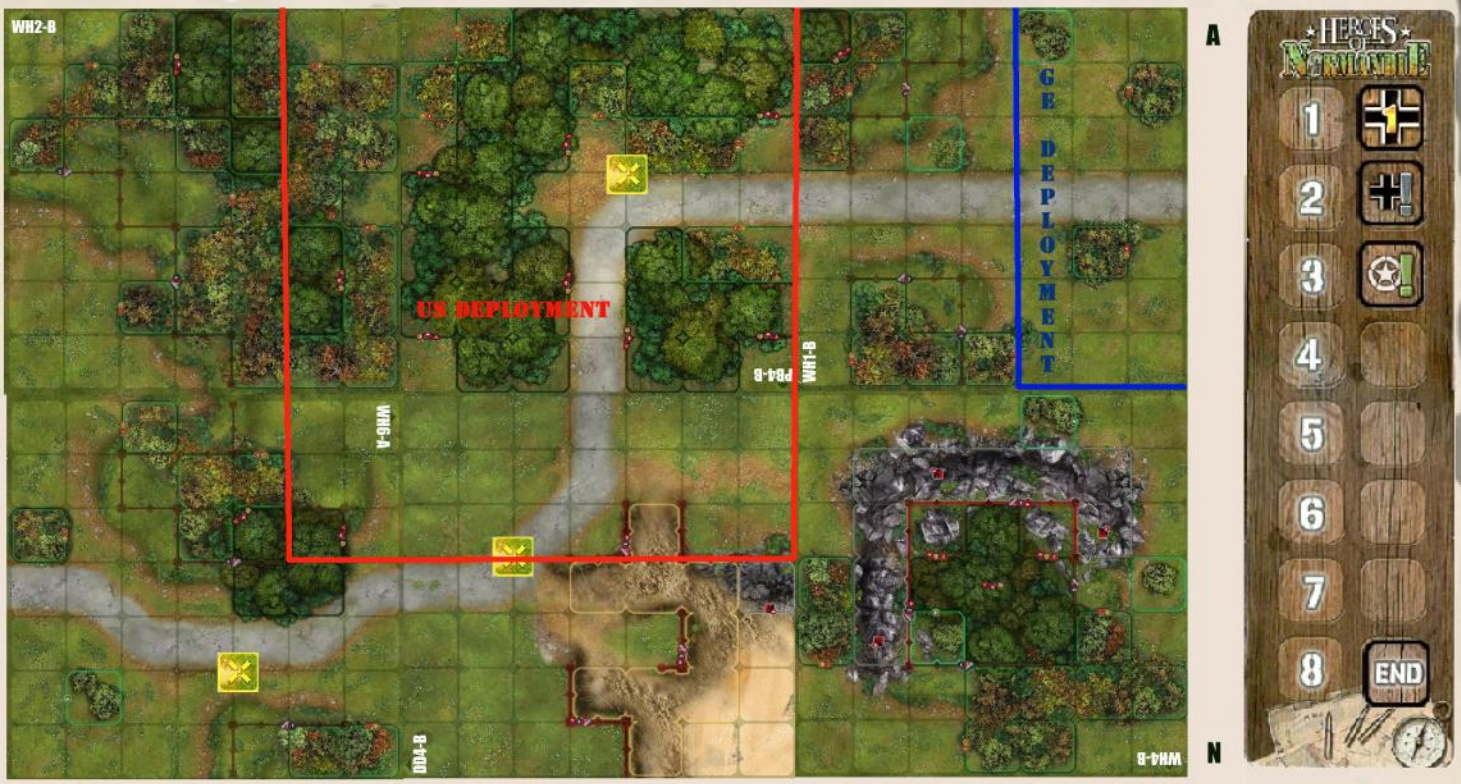
ELEMENTS OF E COMPANY, 2/505TH PIR



ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE HANSEN, 1 SS PANZER DIVISION



BATTLEFIELD



PREPARATION

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from both American and German card decks.
The German player has initiative but the American player deploys first.
Both players draw **4** cards.

SPECIAL RULES

The "**Artillery**" option is the 81mm mortar support (orange template). To make use of this support, "**Big Joe**" must have **LoS** to the target and has to be given an **order** to be spent on requesting the barrage.
"**Big Joe**" enters during turn **1** through the west side of the map.
The units from the "**SS Panzergruppe**" enter through the east side of the map during turn **2**.
"**Vandy**" enters during turn **3** through the south side of the map.
"**Infiltrated**" can only be used by " **Concealed**" units.
"**Fog**" weather conditions apply.
Vehicles cannot cross **contour lines** between different elevations.

The "**57 MM AT Gun**" counter is not placed on the board at the start of the game. As the gun is concealed, the US player secretly writes down its position.
The counter is placed on the map as soon as the gun fires or when an enemy enters the square where the gun is positioned. The German player may in that case decide to assault the gun if possible or retreat into the last square passed before finding the gun.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

The German player wins if the Germans control all three objectives.

Epilogue

The 1 st platoon came under heavy pressure but less than 2 nd platoon that withstood the assault and held its lines thanks to the aid of the mortars.
Meddaugh sends Lt Jensen and his 3 rd platoon to the front in order to reinforce his flank and enfilade the Germans closing in on 2 nd platoon.
Despite bursts of fire from a halftrack, Jensen succeeds.
An American AT gun takes out a German halftrack when suddenly half a dozen Jpz IV appear. Even though hampered by the terrain and several wrecks they threaten to overrun E company.
As the support of F company cannot turn the tide, Vandervoort orders his troops to fall back to the west bank of the Amblève river.

Historical note :
the SS Pz Jg 1 used Jagdpanzer IV.

2-C THE LOST OPPORTUNITY

Trois-Ponts, December 22, 1944 :

Vandervoort returns to his HQ whilst a critical situation looms.
The Germans are on the verge of taking Trois Ponts and Vandy has no other troops to stop them but the HQ company and a detachment of Engineers.
Paratroops and sappers alike dig in on the river bank.
As soon as the last man of E company has crossed the Salm river, the footbridge across the stream is blown up...



COMPOSITION OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF THE HQ COMPANY, 2/505TH PIR AND THE 55TH COMBAT ENGINEER BATTALION





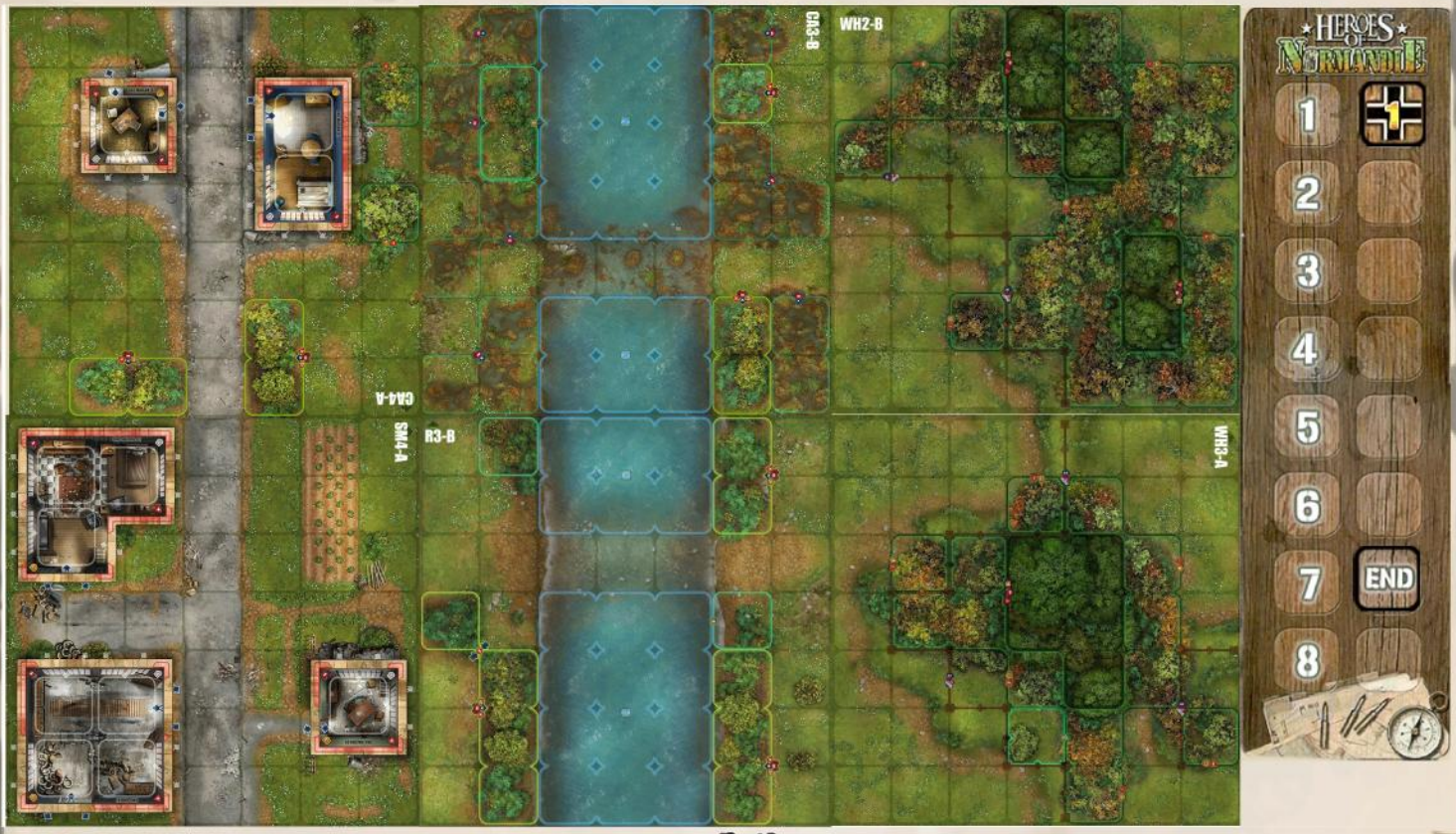
ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE HANSEN, 1 SS PANZER DIVISION







BATTLEFIELD



PREPARATION

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from both American and German card decks.
The German player has initiative but the American player deploys first.
Both players draw **4** cards.

SPECIAL RULES

The Americans are deployed west of the river.
The Germans are placed east of the **contour line** on tile **WH2-B** and **WH3-A**
"Fog" weather conditions apply.
Vehicles cannot cross the river.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

The German player wins if there is at least **1** German unit on the west side of the river at the end of the game.

Epilogue

As soon as they reach the east bank of the river, the Germans start peppering the paratroops in Trois Ponts.
The Americans are well entrenched though, the Germans, on the contrary, are caught in the open and immediately suffer the bloody results when the defenders of the town return fire.
The Germans cease their attack and thus pass up an opportunity to break through the American lines.
Meanwhile Company E has rallied quickly and also taken up positions on the west bank.
On December 23, Kampfgruppe Hansen tries once more in the sector of 3/505 th but again to no avail...

Conclusion

After being pushed back from the left bank of the Amblève, Peiper regroups his forces at La Gleize. Threatened on all sides by the 30 th Infantry Division, he is cut off from the rest of Leibstandarte SS Adolf Hitler.
Although the 1 SS is stopped, further south the 5. Panzerarmee succeeds in penetrating deeply into US lines.
Once again, the 1 st US Army becomes part of Montgomery's army group to simplify chain of command.
It is the British General's opinion that the troops around St-Vith are dangerously exposed. Time to reduce the frontline...